

Workshop #1

*Cutting-edge Alternative Models and Essential Non-Scientific Skills
for Implementing Advanced R&I*

29 September – 02 October 2026 | Porto, Portugal

Period	29 September – 02 October 2026
Format	Hybrid (online + on-site)
Venue	i3S – Universidade do Porto, Rua Alfredo Allen 208, 4200-135 Porto, Portugal
Organizers	i3S (Instituto de Investigação e Inovação em Saúde) & C.RIS Pharma
Target Audience	PhD students, early-stage researchers and technical staff involved in preclinical and translational research at consortium institutions

Objectives

Workshop #1 aims to strengthen capacities in advanced New Approach Methodologies (NAMs) and to provide complementary training in essential non-scientific skills required for high-quality R&I. It will support participants in implementing robust experimental approaches aligned with European standards.

Thematic Content

Topic 1 – Advanced Cell Models & High-Throughput Screening

Culture of spheroids and organoids / in vivo CAM assays / High-throughput screening with 2D/3D cellular models.

Participants will be introduced to state-of-the-art 2D and 3D cellular models, including spheroids and organoids, as well as in vivo CAM assays. The module will also address high-throughput screening approaches for analyzing 2D/3D samples.

Topic 2 – Good Laboratory Practices & guidelines to reach a HRS4R Label

This module will cover Good Laboratory Practices (GLP) and the institutional requirements for obtaining the Human Resources Strategy for Researchers (HRS4R) label, with a focus on quality assurance and transparent, merit-based recruitment practices.



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Indicative Programme (Preliminary)

Phase I – Online (early September 2026)

3 days of theoretical foundations on NAMs, applications and main procedures.

PHASE I — ONLINE (Theoretical Foundations)	
Module 1	Cell and Advanced In Vitro Models: Introduction to 2D vs 3D models, Organoids & Spheroids, Organ-on-chip
Module 2	Bioimaging: Electron Microscopy, Advanced Light Microscopy, Image Stream
Module 3	Mechanobiology: Rheology, Atomic Force Microscopy (AFM)
Module 4	CAM Assays (Chorioallantoic Membrane)
Module 5	Drug Discovery: High-Throughput Screening (HTS), High-Content Screening (HCS)
Module 6	Preclinical imaging: MRI, Micro-CT, Ultrasounds, Rodent Refinement Techniques

Phase II – On-Site at Porto (29 Sept – 02 Oct 2026)

4 days of hands-on training in advanced cell culture techniques, high-throughput screening methodologies + HRS4R session.

PHASE II — ONSITE (Hands-on training modules)	
Topic 1 sessions	
Module 1	2D and 3D Models
Module 2	Gastric organoids and vascular spheroids
Module 3	Organ-on-chip: applications
Module 4	Electron Microscopy
Module 5	Advanced Light Microscopy
Module 6	Rheology and Atomic Force Microscopy (AFM)
Module 7	Chorioallantoic Membrane (CAM) Assays
Module 8	High-Throughput Screening (HTS) and High-Content Screening (HCS)
Module 9	Micro-CT
Module 10	Rodent Refinement Techniques
Topic 2 sessions	

HRS4R Framework: institutional requirements, research integrity, quality assurance, and transparent recruitment practices



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Phase III – Online (October 2026)

GLP sessions on in vitro and ex vivo assays. Implementation in partner institutions — led by C.RIS Pharma.

PHASE III — ONLINE (GLP Sessions — C.RIS Pharma)	
Session A	Good Laboratory Practices (GLP) in in vitro and ex vivo assays
Session B	How to implement GLP in your institution
Session C	Quality assurance and regulatory compliance for preclinical research

Target Audience

PhD students, early-stage researchers, and technical staff involved in preclinical and translational research at the consortium institutions.

Expected Outcomes

Upon completion of Workshop #1, participants will be able to:

- Acquire practical skills in advanced cell culture systems and integrate NAMs (New Approach Methodologies) into experimental and research workflows.
- Develop a broad understanding of advanced biomedical research technologies, including bioimaging, mechanobiology, HTS and HCS.
- Strengthen the ability to design, perform and critically evaluate translational research approaches using innovative *in vitro* and preclinical techniques.
- Understand regulatory and quality requirements for preclinical research, including the basic principles of GLP.
- Gain awareness of the institutional requirements for obtaining the HRS4R label, particularly regarding research integrity, ethical standards and open, transparent, merit-based recruitment practices.

Implementation and Logistics

The workshop will combine online preparatory sessions with on-site practical training in equipped laboratory facilities. Digital platforms will support remote learning components.

GLP online session

Monitoring and Evaluation

Participant feedback will be collected through structured questionnaires. Key indicators include number of participants, and satisfaction level.

Dissemination

The workshop will be advertised through the project website and institutional channels. Learning materials will be shared with participants through online platforms, ensuring accessibility and facilitating further consultation after the workshop.



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Practical Information – Getting to WS#1

Venue

i3S – Instituto de Investigação e Inovação em Saúde, Universidade do Porto

Rua Alfredo Allen, 208 | 4200-135 Porto, Portugal

Tel: +351 226 074 900 | Website: www.i3s.up.pt



Getting There

A. From Porto Airport (Francisco Sa Carneiro)

Directions from the airport to i3S by **metro**:

- Take line E (direction: Estádio do Dragão) at the Airport station.
- Alight at Trindade and change to line D (direction: Hospital São João).
- Final destination station : Pólo Universitário.

Journey time: approx. 45 min | Single ticket: 2.25 EUR | More info: <https://en.metrodoporto.pt/>

B. From Porto Train Stations

Metro or bus are available from Campanhã or São Bento train station. However, the metro is the easiest way to reach i3S.

From Campanhã station:

- Metro: all lines (A, B, C, E, F). Go to Trindade, then change to line D – yellow (direction: Hospital Sao Joao) and alight at Polo Universitario.

Journey time: approx. 25 min | Single ticket: 1.40 EUR | More info: <https://en.metrodoporto.pt/>

From São Bento station :

- Metro: line D – yellow (direction: Hospital Sao Joao). Alight at Polo Universitario. Direct line – no connection required.

Journey time: approx. 10 min | Single ticket: 1.40 EUR | More info: <https://en.metrodoporto.pt/>



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C. By Car

GPS coordinates of i3S: 41 deg 10' 30.008" N, 8 deg 36' 12.488" W.

Please note: i3S does not offer parking. Plan to park nearby or use public transport.

Accommodation in Porto

Hotels within walking distance of i3S

The following hotels are located within 25 minutes' walk of the workshop venue.

Hotel	Contact	Distance
Hotel Ibis Sao Joao ★★	Rua Dr. Plácido Costa 4200-450 Porto Tel: (+351) 225 513 100 Email: H3227@ACCOR.COM	10 min walk
Eurostars Oporto Hotel ★★★★	Rua do Mestre Guilherme Camarinha, 212 4200-537 Porto Tel: (+351) 225 072 090 Email: reservas@eurostarsporto.com	15 min walk
Axis Porto Business & SPA Hotel ★★★★	Rua Maria Feliciano, 100 – Matosinhos 4465-283 Porto Tel: (+351) 229 052 000 Email: reservas@axisporto.com	25 min walk



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Hotels accessible by metro from Porto city centre

These hotels are located in the city centre and easily reachable by metro (line D, alight at Polo Universitario).

Hotel	Contact	Journey time
Pao de Acucar Hotel ★★★	Rua do Almada, 262 4050-032 Porto Tel: (+351) 222 002 425 Email: respaodeacucar@gmail.com	~15 min
Trindade Porto Hotel ★★★★	Rua de Camoes, n 129/131 4000-144 Porto Tel: (+351) 222 061 520 Email: geral@portotrindadehotel.com	~15 min
Hotel Porto Moov Centro ★★	Praca da Batalha 32 4000-101 Porto Tel: (+351) 220 407 000 Email: portocentro@hotelmoov.com	~20 min
Legendary Porto Hotel ★★★	Praca da Batalha, 127-130 4000-102 Porto Tel: (+351) 223 392 300 Email: legendaryportohotel@continentalhotels.eu	~20 min
Hotel Moon & Sun Porto ★★★★	R. de Sa de Noronha 70, 4050-526 Porto Tel: (+351) 222 081 875 Email: geral@ms-hotels.com	~20 min
Oca Oriental Porto Hotel ★★★★	R. do Padre Antonio Vieira 83, 4300-031 Porto Tel: (+351) 221 450 307 Email: reservas.oriental@ocahotels.pt	~20 min
HF Tuela Porto ★★★	R. Arquitecto Marques da Silva 200, 4150-483 Porto Tel: (+351) 226 004 747 Email: booking.tuela@hfhotels.com	~30 min
HF Fenix Porto ★★★★	Rua Goncalo Sampaio, 282, 4150-365 Porto Tel: (+351) 226 071 800 Email: booking.fenixporto@hfhotels.com	~30 min
Hotel da Musica	Largo Ferreira Lapa, 21 a 183, 4150-323 Porto Tel: (+351) 226 076 000 Email: res.hmp@hoteldamusica.com	~30 min



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